CURRICULUM VITAE FOR BLESSINGS MLOWOKA

Date of Birth	**:**	**19.03.1984**
Country of citizenship/Residence	**:**	Malawi
Education	**:**	**ACADEMIC QUALIFICATION** • MBA – Disaster Management | Central Christian University, Malawi | 2022–2024 • BSc – Environmental Management | Central Christian University, Malawi | 2016–2018 • Advanced Diploma – Rural Community Development | University of Malawi (Polytechnic) | 2008–2010. • Certificate – Geospatial Data Management for DRM | Malawi University of Science & Technology | 2021_Malawi. • Certificate – International Disaster Law & Legislature | IFRC & Caribbean DRM | 2021_Kenya • Malawi School Certificate of Education (MSCE) | Katoto Secondary School, Malawi | 2000–2003 **OTHER TRAININGS ATTENDED:** • IFRC Global Surge Capacity Training – Emergency Needs Assessment & DRM | 2022 • Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) TOT Training- Malawi • Gender Based Violence in Emergencies by University of Malawi_ Chancellor College 2025 • Certificate – Community Engagement and Accountability (CEA) • Certificate – Participatory Approach for Safe Shelter Awareness (PASSA) • Resilience Tool Kit and Participatory Scenario Planning

Employment Record

Period	Employing Organization and your Title/Position. Contact Information for References	Country	Roles and Responsibilities done
January 2025 to date	**Name of Employer:** Self Help Africa **Name of Position:** NGO Humanitarian Committee Coordinator. **Reference:** Name: Smorden Tomoka Email: smorden.tomoka@selfhelpafrica.org	Malawi	• Coordinating and providing technical guidance 22 NGOs (Plan Malawi, World Vision, Concern, CARE, Oxfam, YONECO, CARD, etc.). Liaison with DoDMA, UNRCO, ICCG, FCDO for national humanitarian & nutrition coordination. Donors ECHO, USAID, FCDO, Irish Aid. • Support the capacity gaps of the member organisations and link them to potential donors and partners. • Coordinating Preparedness, Early warning, Anticipatory Actions, Interagency UN Committee interventions in Malawi.
October 2024 to June 2026	**Name of Employer:** OIKOLOGICA-Spain & EAD (Malawi) **Name of Position:** Climate Change Expert / Country Manager **Reference:** Name: Veronika Macku Email: veronikamacku@oikologica.com	Malawi	• Led Malawi's National Adaptation Plan (NAP) process, integrating economic appraisal and a financing strategy. • Conducted Climate Vulnerability and Risk Assessments (CVRAs) in 11 districts to inform local adaptation priorities. • Provided policy advisory support to the Environmental Affairs Department (EAD). Strengthened assessment and research through data driven analysis, vulnerability mapping, and stakeholder engagement to support evidence-based decision-making and resilience planning.

			• Development of the Economic Appraisal and financing strategy the National Adaptation Plan Readiness Project in Malawi
May 2024 to January 2025	**Name of Employer:** Hope Ministries International (HOMI) **Name of Position:** Head of Programs and Operations **Reference:** Name: Jessica Kalanje Email: hopeforallmalawi@gmail.com	Malawi	• Oversaw program synergy, compliance, fundraising, and donor partnerships • Strengthened assessment and research through data-driven analysis, vulnerability mapping, and stakeholder engagement to support evidence-based decision-making and resilience planning. • Support CBO partners in capacity building.
May 2020 – May 2024	**Name of Employer** International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC**)** /Malawi Red Cross Society. **Name of Position:** Emergency Operations Manager **Reference:** Name: Gerardo Escalanteh Email: Gerardoescalanteh@gmail.com	Malawi	• Provided integrated leadership across food response, disaster management, and resilience programming, serving as Project Manager for WFP food response, CERF Focal Person, and Malawi Red Cross representative to the National Emergency Operations Centre (DoDMA/UN) • Led early warning systems and anticipatory action, while coordinating preparedness, response, and recovery efforts, including deployment as an IFRC SADC Surge Team member. • Managed resilience and livelihoods programming (climate-smart agriculture, social protection, forest restoration) alongside large-scale cyclone responses (Freddy, Ana, Idai, Kenneth, Gombe) and USAID-funded climate projects across Malawi and Zimbabwe, overseeing CHF 6M+ operations • Ensured strategic and operational oversight across programs, including emergency response, logistics, budgeting, compliance, and MEAL systems, strengthening data-driven decision-making, risk management, and quality delivery
Sep 2016 – April 2024	**Name of Employer:** Malawi Red Cross Society ✓ UN-IOM CERF Project ✓ ECHO Projects. **Name of Position:** Project Coordinator **Reference:** Name: 5. Letitia Kleij Email: letitia_kleij@hotmail.com	Malawi	• Implemented a 5-month Cyclone Freddy emergency shelter and camp management response in Southern Malawi, with UN-IOM support through CERF, reaching 800 displaced households with cash, NFIs, and improved camp coordination in Mulanje, Chikwawa and Phalombe. • Coordinated resilience, early action, and anticipatory projects in Blantyre, Zomba, Thyolo, and Karonga. ECHO and IFRC Funded projects.
Jun 2014 – Jul 2016	**Name of Employer:** Self Help Africa **Name of Position:** Deputy Program Manager **Reference:** Name: Isaac Sangweni Email: isaac.sangweni@selfhelpafrica.net	Malawi	• Led Disaster Risk Management (DRR), early warning systems, and resilience programming, including climate-smart agriculture and irrigation initiatives • Directed assessments, baselines, evaluations, and project design to ensure evidence-based, high-impact interventions

			• Coordinated and led the DISCOVER Consortium on DRR and food security, strengthening multi-partner collaboration • Promoted renewable energy, FMNR, and land restoration to enhance sustainable livelihoods and ecosystem recovery • Managed ECHO and DFID-funded programs, ensuring compliance, quality delivery, and donor alignment
Jul 2012 – May 2014	**Name of Employer: Goal Global** **Name of Position:** Disaster Risk Reduction Coordinator. **Reference:** Name: Steve Kamtimaleka Email: skamtimaleka@gmail.com	Malawi and Mozambique	• Led coordination of Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) initiatives, embedding early warning systems across all projects to enhance preparedness and timely response • Supported implementation of Disaster Risk Management (DRM) and Cash Voucher Assistance (CVA) programs in Nsanje, Chikwawa, and Balaka for vulnerable populations • Oversaw ECHO and Irish Aid-funded programs, ensuring compliance, quality delivery, and achievement of intended humanitarian results
Oct 2010 – Jun 2012	**Name of Employer:** COOPI International, Italy **Name of Position:** DRM Centre Manager **Reference:** Name: Alexandre.Castellano Email: Alexandre.Castellano@echofield.eu	Malawi and Mozambique	• Managed Disaster Risk Management (DRM) Centres, overseeing staff, budgets, programs, and partnerships in coordination with the DRM Manager and Country Manager • Served as the primary representative and liaison with local authorities, donors, media, and key stakeholders • Coordinated development of operational procedures and innovations to improve efficiency, cost-effectiveness, and timely project implementation • Engaged donors and co-financing partners to ensure timely resource mobilization and availability • Provided technical leadership in recruitment and supervision of contractors and consultants in line with COOPI policies and donor requirements • Established and managed DRM Centres in Salima, Lilongwe, and Kasungu
February to August 2010	**Name of Employer: Department of Disaster Management Affairs (DoDMA)** **Name of Position: Mitigation Officer** **Reference:** Name: Dr. Stern Kita Email: stenkita@gmail.com	Malawi Government	• Support the implementation of disaster mitigation interventions at national level within the Department of Disaster Management Affairs (DoDMA) in Malawi • Coordinated NGOs in the development of national risk mapping to inform planning and prioritization • Support the development of contingency plans and Disaster Risk Management (DRM) plans across sectors and clusters • Guided mitigation works and provides policy and technical oversight to consultancies in line with national DRM frameworks

MEMBERSHIP OF PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS:

1. IFRC Global Surge

2. International Meal Family (Global)
3. Global Evergreening Alliance Go Green
4. Member of Malawi Meteorological Society
5. Member of Project Management Institute (PMI), Malawi Chapter
6. Member of Global Anticipatory Action
7. Population Matters
8. Planetary Health

PUBLICATIONS AND RESEARCH:

- Mlowoka. B (2013) A guide to Community resilience: A child to child in DRR
- DISCOVER Revised Standards (2013), DRR and Early Warning System Standards
- Mlowoka B. (2014) Disaster response and early warning system training manual for disaster risk management and early warning system training of trainers.

SUMMARY BIOGRAPHY:

Blessings Mlowoka is a seasoned humanitarian, resilience, and development professional with over 15 years of progressive experience in multi-hazard risk assessment, disaster risk management (DRM), early warning systems, and human security analysis. He has a strong track record of supporting governments, international organizations, and NGOs in designing and implementing evidence-based, conflict-sensitive, and resilience-focused interventions across Malawi and the Southern Africa region.

He brings extensive expertise in risk and vulnerability assessments, including leading Climate Vulnerability and Risk Assessments (CVRAs), hazard and infrastructure risk analyses, and contributing to Malawi's National Adaptation Plan (NAP) through economic appraisal and climate financing strategy development. His work aligns closely with donors' frameworks, integrating multi-sectoral risk analysis across environment, food security, governance, health, and socio-economic systems.

Blessings has strong experience delivering end-to-end assessment processes consistent with different methodologies including desktop research, baseline studies, stakeholder mapping, field data collection (KIIs and FGDs), mixed-methods analysis, and validation workshops, culminating in high-quality technical reports that inform policy and programming decisions.

He is highly skilled in Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Anticipatory Action, having pioneered community-based early warning systems in Malawi and supported national-level early warning integration across programs. His work strengthens the link between risk analysis, early warning, and early response, enhancing preparedness and crisis prevention.

In his operational leadership roles, Blessings has managed large-scale, multi-sector humanitarian and resilience programs (exceeding CHF 6 million) across Malawi and Zimbabwe, including major cyclone responses (Freddy, Idai, Ana, Gombe, and Kenneth). He has successfully integrated risk analysis into emergency response, recovery, and long-term resilience programming, covering sectors such as livelihoods, climate-smart agriculture, social protection, WASH, and shelter.

Blessings possesses strong expertise in Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) systems, including baseline and endline evaluations, data quality assessments, vulnerability mapping, and institutional data management. He consistently promotes data-driven decision-making and results-based management, in line with international financing institution standards.

He has extensive experience working with multi-stakeholder coordination platforms, including government institutions, UN agencies, NGOs, and regional mechanisms, supporting joint assessments, early warning systems, and response planning. He has also managed and delivered programs funded by

	major donors including ECHO, FCDO/DFID, USAID, Irish Aid, and AfDB/UNEP, ensuring compliance, quality assurance, and effective resource utilization. Academically, Blessings holds a Master of Business Administration (Disaster Management) and a Bachelor of Science in Environmental Management, complemented by certifications in Geospatial Data for DRM, International Disaster Law, and Emergency Needs Assessment. He is also a recognized contributor to global resilience initiatives, including anticipatory action and ecosystem restoration. Blessings combines technical depth, field experience, and strategic leadership, making him highly suited to support multi-hazard risk and human security assessments, strengthen early warning systems, and deliver high-quality analytical outputs that inform regional stability, resilience, and policy development.

OTHER ASSIGNMENTS:

Name of Project:
Economic Appraisal and financing strategy consultancy services for the National Adaptation Plan Readiness Project in Malawi
Year: 2025 to 2026
Location: Malawi
Client: Climate Technology Centre and Network
(CTCN), United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

Main Project Features: National Adaptation plan, Economic and financing strategy
Position Held: National Climate Change Expert
Activities Performed:

- Led the development of Malawi's National Adaptation Plan (NAP), integrating economic appraisal and a financing strategy
- Conducted Climate Vulnerability and Risk Assessments (CVRAs) across 11 districts to inform local adaptation priorities
- Provided policy advisory support to the Environmental Affairs Department (EAD) on climate and resilience planning
- Strengthened assessment and research through data-driven analysis, vulnerability mapping, and stakeholder engagement to inform evidence-based decision-making
- Developed the economic appraisal and financing strategy under the National Adaptation Plan Readiness Project in Malawi

Name of Project: Road Vulnerability Assessment for Malawi RESTORE Project
Year: 2024
Location: Malawi and Mozambique
Client: Pacific Consults-Japan (World Bank)

Main Project Features:
Position Held: Malawi Research Assistant
Activities Performed:

- Conducted field assessments and data analysis on climate-related vulnerabilities affecting Malawi's Lower Shire Valley road network, linking infrastructure risks to broader community resilience.
- Evaluated economic and social risks of climate events to transport infrastructure, providing actionable insights for risk-informed planning and early warning systems.
- Developed recommendations to prioritize climate-resilient rehabilitation of roads, enhancing connectivity for trade, agriculture, and tourism while reducing disaster exposure.
- Supported the World Bank RESTORE Project with evidence-based analyses to guide investment decisions, integrating resilience and anticipatory action principles.

Name of Project: Produce Digitalised Village and Key Project Feature Maps with
Supporting System for the THRIVE Project
Year: 2022
Location: Malawi
Client: GS Consults (World Vision Project)
Main Project Features:

Position Held: CVRA Expert
Activities Performed:

- Conducted Climate Vulnerability and Risk Assessments (CVRAs) across 11 districts to identify exposure, sensitivity, and adaptive capacity of communities and infrastructure to climate hazards.
- Collected, georeferenced, and digitized spatial data for impact areas, including hazard and vulnerability zonation for natural and man-made risks.
- Developed a comprehensive geodatabase and a user-friendly national-level GIS platform to support evidence-based decision-making and planning.
- Prepared metadata, documentation, and high-quality maps for project impact areas and overall national coverage, integrating climate, social, and infrastructure data.
- Engaged stakeholders through data validation and participatory mapping, ensuring the assessments informed local adaptation priorities and resilience planning.
- Produced analytical outputs linking CVRA findings to policy guidance, risk-informed project design, and investment planning in climate-resilient transport and infrastructure.

Name of Project: Development of Social Marketing Tools in DRR through (Department of Disaster Management Affairs (DoDMA), United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Malawi Institute of Education (MIE)
Year: 2022
Location: Malawi
Client: Health Songs International (UNDP Project)
Main Project Features:
Position Held: Malawi Field Manager
Activities Performed:

- Stakeholder Mapping & Coordination: Identified and engaged key stakeholders, including schools, youth clubs, and local authorities, to ensure representation of children aged 8–17 in both rural and urban areas.
- Field Support & Logistics: Organized FGDs, KIIs, workshops, and community activities, ensuring smooth participation and operational support.
- Technical Guidance: Advised on culturally appropriate methods for engaging children and youth in DRR awareness, including creative approaches like game play and song writing.
- Capacity Building & Knowledge Sharing: Facilitated knowledge exchange with DoDMA, schools, and communities to strengthen understanding of local disaster risks and youth engagement strategies.
- Monitoring & Reporting: Supported documentation, analysis, and reporting of project activities to UNDP and partners, ensuring compliance with the ToR and quality standards.

Name of Project: Development of early warning system tool kit
Year: 2019
Location: Malawi
Client: COOPI (ECHO Project)
Main Project Features:
Position Held: Development of early warning system tool kit
Activities Performed:

- Collaborated with lead consultants and program managers to design an Early Warning System toolkit for Malawi.
- Engaged government agencies, local authorities, and communities to ensure the toolkit reflected local needs.
- Collected, analysed, and mapped hazard and vulnerability data to inform early warning protocols.
- Supported training sessions to build the capacity of local staff and partners on EWS usage.
- Contributed to drafting manuals, guidance notes, and final reports for practical implementation.

Expert's contact information	**:**	+265 888 755 333 ; mlowokablessings@gmail.com Blessings Mlowoka 